

FILM DOSSIER: X-MEN

Phase 1 · Film #7

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE.  Waiting on the showrunner's real-actor casting picks (see Section 2).

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	7 of 29
Phase	Phase 1
Real title	<i>X-MEN</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"HOMEROOM"</i>
Release date	Friday, November 4, 2011
Distributor	Paramount Pictures
Director	Matthew Vaughn
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 158 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + coming-of-age school drama / civil-rights allegory

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	The X-Men franchise belongs to the X-Men ensemble (real actors, the showrunner's picks). Grace Bullock's Scarlet Witch makes her debut here, and her franchise home is the Avengers , following 616.

Fictional-ensemble cast

Character	Actor	Age at release
Wanda Maximoff / The Scarlet Witch	Grace Bullock	27 (<i>looks 22</i>)

Real-actor cast: ⌚ SHOWRUNNER'S PICKS

The Casting Rules say the showrunner chooses when more than one real actor has played the role. On 616 in 1963, the five students were teenagers and Xavier and Magneto were middle-aged.

Character	Option A	Option B	Notes
Professor Charles Xavier	Patrick Stewart (71)	James McAvoy (32)	Stewart fits 616's bald, middle-aged Xavier of 1963
Magneto (Max Eisenhardt)	Ian McKellen (72)	Michael Fassbender (34)	In 2011, 616 Magneto is a Holocaust survivor with a de-aged, physically prime body . Both options work.
Cyclops (Scott Summers)	James Marsden (38)	Tye Sheridan (14)	Sheridan is closer to 616's teenage Scott
Marvel Girl (Jean Grey)	Famke Janssen (46)	Sophie Turner (15)	Turner is closer to 616's teenage Jean
The Beast (Hank McCoy)	Kelsey Grammer (56)	Nicholas Hoult (21)	Hoult fits the 1963 Beast, who is human-looking with huge hands and feet
Iceman (Bobby Drake)	Shawn Ashmore (32)	–	⚠️ The only real actor to play him. He's older than 616's youngest X-Man, so Bobby is written as the "kid" who looks older.
The Angel (Warren Worthington III)	Ben Foster (31)	Ben Hardy (20)	
Quicksilver (Pietro Maximoff)	Evan Peters (24)	Aaron Taylor-Johnson (21)	Peters is closer in age to Grace, who plays his twin
The Toad (Mortimer Toynbee)	Ray Park (37)	–	The only real actor to play him
Mastermind (Jason Wyngarde)	Fresh casting	–	Never played by a real actor
Dr. Bolivar Trask	Peter Dinklage (42)	–	The only real actor to play him
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a man watering his lawn as the Blackbird passes overhead</i>)	Stan Lee (88)	–	–

Bold = the recommended option, pending the showrunner's confirmation.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>The X-Men #1</i> (September 1963), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby: the school, Jean Grey's arrival, Magneto's attack on Cape Citadel . <i>The X-Men #4</i> (March 1964): the Brotherhood of Evil Mutants , the Scarlet Witch and Quicksilver , and the takeover of San Marco . <i>The X-Men #11</i> (May 1965): the Stranger takes Magneto into space.
Supporting comics	<i>X-Men #7</i> (1964, Cerebro) · <i>X-Men #14–16</i> (1965, Bolivar Trask and the Sentinels) · <i>X-Men #4</i> (Magneto saved Wanda from a mob, which is why the twins feel they owe him) · <i>Avengers #16</i> (1965, where the twins go next)
Nerf check	✓ Magneto can move ships and missiles . It takes all five X-Men and Xavier together to stop him, and in the end a cosmic being decides it, not the X-Men.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96% . It combines <i>X-Men #1</i> , <i>#4</i> and <i>#11</i> . The costumes, codenames and the era-accurate versions of the powers are exact.

Straight from the page:

- **Xavier's School for Gifted Youngsters**, 1407 Graymalkin Lane, Salem Center, Westchester County, NY.
- The five original X-Men: **Cyclops, the Beast, Iceman, the Angel, and Marvel Girl**, who **arrives as the new student in #1**. They wear **matching blue-and-gold training uniforms**.
- **Magneto attacks the Cape Citadel missile base** in #1.
- **The Brotherhood of Evil Mutants**: Magneto, **Mastermind, the Toad, Quicksilver** and **the Scarlet Witch**. They take over the South American republic of **San Marco** (#4).
- **The twins serve Magneto out of a debt**: he saved Wanda from a mob in their Eastern European village (*X-Men #4*). **They don't know he's their father** (on 616 they learn this in 1982), and they're reluctant members.
- **Iceman's first form is a SNOWMAN** (#1), and **the Beast is human-looking with enormous hands and feet** (1963). The blue fur comes in 1970.
- **Jean's telepathy has been blocked by Xavier** (616). In this film **she only uses telekinesis**, as in the early comics.
- **The Stranger**, a vast cosmic being, **appears out of nowhere and takes Magneto and the Toad** into space (#11). **With Magneto gone, the twins walk away**.

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

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| *X-Men #1*, *#4* and *#11* (1963–65) are condensed into one film | Runtime. Magneto's arc runs from his first attack to his removal. |

| Bolivar Trask (1965) appears early | It sets up the Sentinels and the anti-mutant climate that defines the franchise. |

| Iceman's actor is older than 616's youngest X-Man | Casting Rules. See Section 2. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Professor X	The most powerful telepath on Earth: reads and controls minds, mind blasts, memory wipes, astral projection ; boosted by Cerebro (<i>X-Men</i> #1, #7)	All of it: he freezes a whole missile base's staff in place, and fights Mastermind's illusions on the astral plane	–	✓ 100%
Cyclops	Uncontrollable optic blasts (concussive force); a ruby-quartz visor ; a master of trick-shot angles; a born leader (<i>X-Men</i> #1)	Blasts through a tank's armor; banks shots off walls	–	✓ 100%
Marvel Girl	Telekinesis in 1963 (telepathy blocked by Xavier) (<i>X-Men</i> #1)	Stops a falling missile in midair; lifts a car	Telepathy (616 timing), and the Phoenix Force (616, 1976), which is a far future story, not a nerf	✓ 100%
The Beast	Superhuman strength and agility ; enormous hands and feet; super-genius (<i>X-Men</i> #1)	Acrobatics through the Danger Room, holding up a collapsing girder	The blue-furred form (616, 1970)	✓ 100%
Iceman	Generates ice and extreme cold ; the snowman form (1963)	The snowman form, ice slides, freezing a Brotherhood jeep solid	His clear ice form and Omega-level potential (616 later)	✓ 100%
The Angel	Feathered wings: flight, speed, altitude (<i>X-Men</i> #1)	Catches Jean in a 5,000-foot fall	–	✓ 100%
Magneto	Master of magnetism: lifts ships, tanks and missiles; force fields; flight ; bends steel; the electromagnetic spectrum; brilliant strategist (<i>X-Men</i> #1)	Pulls a Navy destroyer out of the sea , turns missiles around, generates force fields, flies, and holds the entire San Marco army at bay	His planet-scale feats (they grow with future threats)	✓ 100%
The Scarlet Witch	The hex power: bolts that alter probability so that unlikely things happen (<i>X-Men</i> #4)	She blows apart a tank's treads with a hex, and makes a rifle jam and a helicopter's rotors come off at once	Her full reality-warping / chaos magic (the later 616 version). Held for the Avengers films, for story reasons, not as a nerf.	✓ 100%
Quicksilver	Superhuman speed (supersonic), reflexes (<i>X-Men</i> #4)	Runs up a waterfall, disarms fifty soldiers in two seconds	–	✓ 100%

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
The Toad	Superhuman leaping and agility (<i>X-Men #4</i>)	Leaps across rooftops	–	✓ 100%
Mastermind	Powerful illusions (<i>X-Men #4</i>)	Traps the X-Men in illusions of their worst fears	–	✓ 100%
The Stranger	A cosmic being of near-limitless power (<i>X-Men #11</i>)	Freezes Magneto in midair, and leaves with him in a flash of light	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	In a world that cheers for gods and armored heroes, five teenagers born with extraordinary powers are feared for them. Their teacher's dream of peace is tested by the one man who knows him best.
Theme	Born, not made. The Avengers chose their powers. Mutants didn't, and the world hates them for it.
Villain / antagonist	Magneto and the Brotherhood of Evil Mutants

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE NEW STUDENT

- **Westchester County, Monday, September 12, 2011.** A teenager named **Jean Grey** arrives at **Xavier's School for Gifted Youngsters**. Four students are waiting: **Scott, Hank, Bobby and Warren**.
- The **Danger Room**, the blue-and-gold uniforms, the codenames. **Professor Xavier** tells the class that the world isn't ready for them, so they'll protect it anyway.
- On TV, **Dr. Bolivar Trask** argues on a news panel that heroes like Iron Man are one thing, but **mutants are a different threat altogether**.

ACT TWO: THE BROTHERHOOD

- **Magneto** attacks the **Cape Citadel** missile base in Florida and takes control of its missiles.
- The X-Men, on their **first mission**, fight him to a standstill. They save the base, and Magneto escapes.
- The **Brotherhood of Evil Mutants** gathers: **Mastermind**, **the Toad**, and the reluctant twins **Pietro and Wanda Maximoff**, who owe Magneto because he saved Wanda from a mob that wanted to burn her.
- In a quiet scene, Wanda asks Magneto why he protects them. He looks at her far too long before answering: *"Because you are my people."*

ACT THREE: SAN MARCO

- The Brotherhood takes over the small South American republic of **San Marco** as a **mutant homeland**.

- The X-Men go in. Mastermind's illusions, Quicksilver's speed and Wanda's hexes nearly beat them.
 - Wanda is ordered to kill Cyclops, and she refuses.
 - Magneto **raises a destroyer out of the harbor** to crush the X-Men.
 - Before it falls, a **towering figure made of starlight** appears in the sky: **the Stranger**. Everything stops. The Stranger looks at Magneto like a specimen, and **takes him and the Toad**, gone in a flash. The destroyer falls back into the sea.
 - Xavier and his students are left in the silence. The twins are free.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, September 12, 2011 → Saturday, October 22, 2011. Both post-credit scenes are in late October 2011 .
Where it's set	Salem Center, Westchester County, NY (the X-Mansion) · Cape Citadel, Florida · San Marco, South America (filmed in Colombia) · the twins' Eastern European village (flashback)
Relative to other films	Seventeen months after <i>Iron Man 2</i> , and a few months after <i>Captain America's</i> present-day post-credit scenes (mid-2011). The Avengers haven't formed yet.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Mutants and the X-gene:** born, not made, and feared.
- **The X-Mansion**, the **Danger Room**, **Cerebro**, the **Blackbird**.
- **Xavier vs. Magneto**, two friends and two dreams.
- **Trask**, whose Sentinels are coming.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Heroes vs. mutants	Trask's argument: <i>Iron Man is a hero, mutants are a threat.</i> The MCU's politics now have two sides.	Phase 2 onward
The Scarlet Witch & Quicksilver	Freed from Magneto, they walk away	Avengers #16: "Cap's Kooky Quartet" (Phase 2)
S.H.I.E.L.D.	Sitwell watches the San Marco footage. <i>"Fury's going to want to see this."</i>	<i>The Avengers</i>
Cosmic beings exist	The Stranger	The cosmic side of Phase 2

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
The watching mind	The post-credit scene	Thanos is looking at Earth.
The Stranger	On 616, the Stranger is a cosmic entity on the same scale as the beings who hold the Gems	The cosmic hierarchy that Thanos will climb on his way to the Gauntlet

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	 "THE ROAD." A dirt road out of San Marco at dawn. Wanda and Pietro walk away with their bags. PIETRO: <i>"Where do we go now?"</i> WANDA: <i>"Somewhere they don't hate us."</i> A streetlight above her flickers and bursts without her touching it. She doesn't notice. Pietro does.
Post-credit scene	 "CEREBRO." Xavier alone in the Cerebro chamber, at night. He's searching for Magneto across the whole Earth, and finds nothing. Then he goes farther out . His face drains of color. XAVIER (whispering): <i>"Something is watching us. From very, very far away."</i> (beat) <i>"...And it's smiling."</i> CUT TO BLACK.
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "ROAD TRIP." Post-credit: "STARGAZING."

CHECKLIST

- ☒ Comic(s) adapted · ☒ Comic Accuracy Report + powers · ☒ Real and decoy titles · ☒ What it's about · ☒ Villain · ☒ Post-credit scenes · ☒ The film's own world-building · ☒ MCU world-building · ☒ Big Bad setup · ☒ Whose franchise · ☒ When and where in the timeline ·  Real-actor casting picks